Sourdough Baking Log

Reusable template — fill in by hand at each stage

Recipe Name	
Date Baked	
Starting Room Temperature (°F)	
Starting Humidity (%)	

Building a Levain

Build the levain the night before (or morning of) mixing, timed to peak right when you're ready to use it — skip this section if mixing straight from the maintained starter with no separate build.

Starter Type Used (circle one): Standard (100% hydration) Stiff (45–50% hydration)

Build Ratio (starter : flour : water)	
Flour(s) Used in Levain	

Flour(s) used in the levain can differ from the flours in the final dough — e.g. an all-white levain for a milder, less sour result on an enriched or delicate bake. See the Starter Types and Flours and Starter vs. Levain guides.

Ingredient	Weight (g)	Baker's % (of levain flour)
Total Levain Flour		100%
Ripe Starter (carryover)		
Water		
Total Levain Weight		

List each flour on its own line in the open area above if the levain uses more than one.

Time Built	Ferment Temp (°F)	Target Peak Time	Actual Peak Time Reached	Levain Temp at Peak (°F)	pH at Peak (optional)

Ripeness looks different by starter type: a standard starter shows obvious surface bubbles and a loose, aerated rise; a stiff starter domes upward, then flattens and starts to recede at peak, with a softened, slightly cracked surface and a pungent sour smell — don't judge a stiff levain by bubbles alone. Levain Temp at Peak feeds the mixing water calculation in the Mix section below.

Formula — Dough

Ingredient	Weight (g)	Baker's %
Total Flour		100%
Water		
Ripe Starter		
Salt		
Total Dough Weight (before inclusions)		

List each flour on its own line in the open area above — add as many as the recipe calls for.

Formula — Inclusions

Inclusion	Weight (g)	Baker's % (of flour)	Notes
Total Inclusions			

List each inclusion on its own line above — write smaller if a recipe needs more room.

Total Finished Dough Weight (g)	

Timeline

Autolyse

Start Time	End Time	Duration

Mix

Mixing water temp = (Target DDT × 4) − (Levain Temp + Flour Temp + Room Temp + Friction Factor). Friction Factor = 0 for hand mixing.

Method (Manual / Machine — circle)	Target DDT (°F)	Levain / Starter Temp (°F)	Flour Temp (°F)	Room Temp at Mixing (°F)	Friction Factor (°F) — 0 if hand mixing	Calculated Mixing Water Temp (°F)

Mixing water calculation — filled in before you mix.

Mix Start Time	Mix End Time	FDT — Final Dough Temp, measured (°F)

Mix record — filled in as you mix.

Bulk Fermentation

% rise target should match FDT — warmer dough needs a lower rise cutoff (it keeps fermenting hard through shaping and cold retard); cooler dough needs a higher one. A rise percentage alone, without the paired dough temp, isn't a reliable signal.

Dough Temp	Target % Rise	Planning Window
80°F / 27°C	30%+ *	3.5–5.5 hrs
75°F / 24°C	50%	5–7 hrs
70°F / 21°C	75%	8–12 hrs
65°F / 18°C	100%	12–16 hrs

*The Sourdough Journey (Tom Cucuzza), Two-Factor Method — assumes 8–16h cold retard at 38–40°F. * At 78–82°F, also check doming, bubbles, wobble, windowpane, and smell (Bulk-O-Matic) — % rise alone is less reliable at that temperature.*

Stage	Time	Dough Temp (°F)	Dough Observation (feel, volume)
Start			

Log each fold on its own line above (Fold 1, Fold 2, …) — the last entry marks the end of bulk fermentation.

Total Bulk Duration	Target % Rise (per FDT)	Actual % Rise Achieved	pH Check (post-bulk)

Shape

Pre-shape Time	Bench Rest Duration	Final Shape Time

Proof

Method (Room Temp / Cold Retard — circle)	Start Time	End Time	Total Duration	Poke Test Result

Bake

Preheat Temp (°F)	Covered Bake — Start Time	Covered Bake — End Time	Covered Bake Temp (°F)	Uncovered Bake — Start Time	Uncovered Bake — End Time	Uncovered Bake Temp (°F)

Bake stages — filled in as the bake proceeds.

Total Bake Time	Internal Temp at Finish (°F)

Bake summary — filled in once out of the oven.

Cool

Start Time	End Time	Duration

Results & Notes

Oven Spring (circle one): None Moderate Great

Crumb Structure Notes

Crust Notes

Taste Notes

Overall Rating (circle one): 1 2 3 4 5

Changes for Next Time